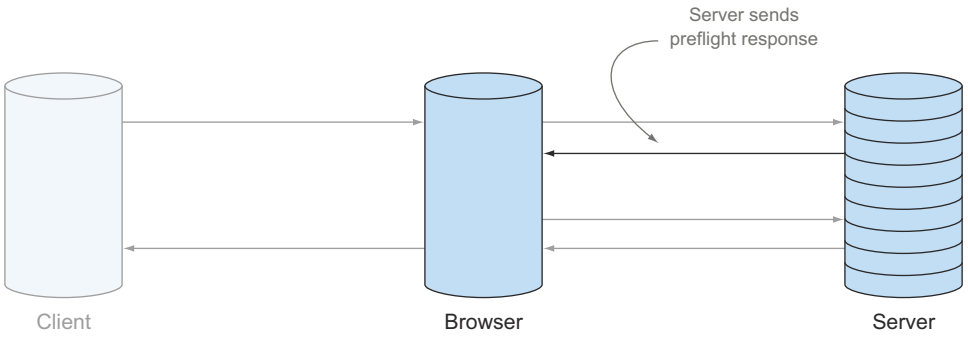


Figure 4.11 After receiving a preflight request, the server sends a preflight response that may grant permissions to make the actual HTTP request.

4.4.1 Supporting HTTP methods with Access-Control-Allow-Methods

Thinking back to the conversation between the browser and the server in figure 4.1, responding to a preflight involves telling the browser that the server accepts `DELETE` requests from different origins. The server does this by setting the Access-Control-Allow-Methods response header as follows:

```
Access-Control-Allow-Methods: DELETE
```

This header indicates that the server grants permissions to the client to make a `DELETE` request to that URL. The Access-Control-Allow-Methods header may look a lot like the Access-Control-Request-Method header, but they're quite different. The Access-Control-Request-Method is a single value that asks permission to use a specific HTTP method. The Access-Control-Allow-Methods header grants permissions to use one or more HTTP methods, and it can have multiple values. If you wanted to open your API endpoint to all HTTP methods, you can put the following values in the Access-Control-Allow-Methods header:

```
Access-Control-Allow-Methods: HEAD, GET, POST, PUT, DELETE
```

Let's turn back to the sample code and update it to respond to the preflight request.

UPDATING THE SAMPLE TO SUPPORT DELETE

The following listing modifies the sample code to respond to the preflight request. If the request is a preflight, the code adds an Access-Control-Allow-Methods header to the response.

Listing 4.5 Modifying `handleCors` to respond to a preflight

```
var handleCors = function(req, res, next) {
  res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Origin', 'http://localhost:1111');
  if (isPreflight(req)) {
    res.set('Access-Control-Allow-Methods', 'GET, DELETE');
    res.status(204).end();
    return;
  }
```

Adds Access-Control-Allow-Methods response header